LORE

Every street has a story.

A pocket-sized AI travel companion that tells you the true, sourced stories of the city around you, through your own earphones. Online or offline. Phone stays in your pocket.

Pre-seed · $1.75M SAFE · $12M post-money cap

Nimit Jain, Founder & CEO · LORE Labs, Inc. (Delaware C-corp, planned) · Nov 2026





Pebble $149 · Square $299 · Atlas $599

Industrial-design renders (design/industrial). Not production units.

THE PROBLEM

In a new city, your phone is your guide, your map, your wallet and your only lifeline. It is bad at all four at once.

Eyes on the screen

Travellers read Wikipedia in front of monuments and still miss what is there. Generic "top 10" lists and audio guides tied to single sites.

Battery dead by 4 pm

Maps, camera, tickets and payments all drain one battery. When it dies you lose navigation, payments and the ability to call for help.

Phone out = target

Greater Rome: 33,455 pickpocketing incidents in 2024 (+68% vs 2019). Holding a phone out marks you as a lost tourist.

Data is still a hassle

>70% of frequent travellers in one survey had experienced roaming bill shock (avg. >€200). eSIMs help, but need setup per trip.

Who feels it most: solo travellers aged 22-45 making 2+ international trips a year. 35-48% of travellers now plan or take solo trips; solo share of Hostelworld bookings is 63%.

Sources: research/trends.md, research/personas.md, research/README.md (quotezone.co.uk pickpocketing aggregation, telecompaper.com roaming survey, Skyscanner/Global Rescue/IMG). Secondary aggregations; indicative.

THE SOLUTION

Walk with a brilliant local friend who knows the history.

01

You walk

Phone in pocket. LORE clipped on or in hand. Your own earphones (LE Audio / A2DP).

02

LORE knows where you face

Map Vision fuses L1+L5 GNSS, 9-axis IMU, steps and building outlines.

03

It tells you what's there

"The building on your right...look up." 20-40 s stories from checked, sourced facts.

04

You go deeper, or not

Press: talk. Double-press: what's around me. Long-press: SOS. Quiet while you cross or talk.

“See the Pantheon behind you? Turn around and look up. The building you see was rebuilt under the emperor Hadrian around 113 to 125 AD. Yet the inscription on the front credits Marcus Agrippa...”

Actual output of the Rome prototype (simulated walk, offline template path). Facts rome-pantheon-1..4, source: en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pantheon,_Rome

Source: software/simulations/output/rome-walk-transcript.md (SIMULATED sensors). Principle D4: the AI tells the story; it cannot invent history.

WHY A DEVICE, NOT JUST AN APP

Phones are bad at three things travellers need. A device fixes them.

Works when the phone doesn't

Built-in global eSIM (Square/Atlas, LTE Cat-1bis, 150+ countries). Phone stolen or flat: you still have stories, maps and SOS.

2+ day battery, separate from the phone

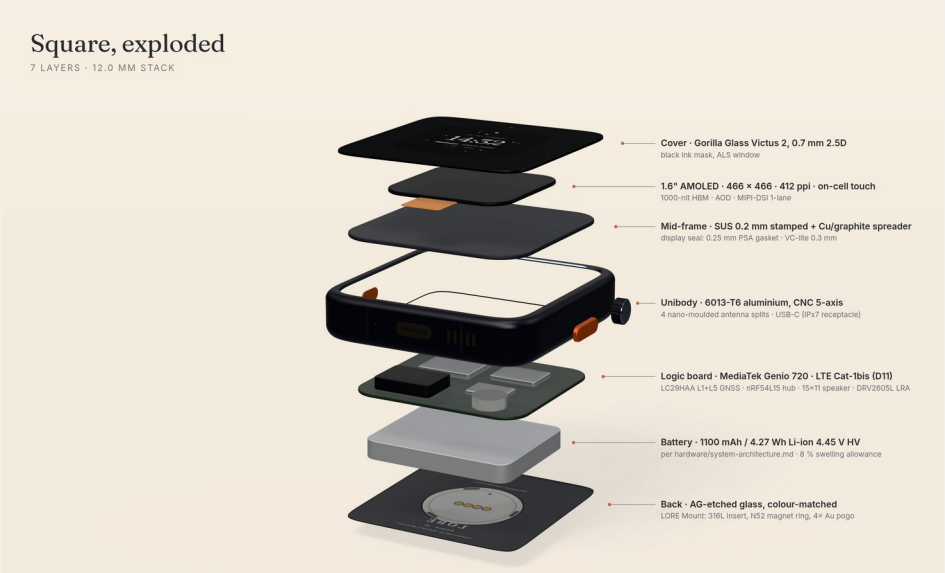
Simulated travel day: Pebble 2.1, Square 2.1, Atlas 2.4 days (new cell, optimised firmware). Phone battery stays for photos and payments.

Offline City Packs

Maps, routing, stories and on-device AI (3B on Square) with no signal. Rome pack: 86 POIs, 215 sourced fact cards today.

Eyes up, phone hidden

Physical controls: press to talk, double-press 'what's around me', long-press SOS. Walk-me-home check-ins.



Honest test (Gate G0): if the phone app alone delivers ≥80% of the value, we ship the app first and keep the device as a premium model (decision D1).

Sources: COMPANY.md 'why buy'; hardware/simulations/results.md (SIMULATED battery); software/README.md; company/decisions-log.md D1, D11.

THE PRODUCT FAMILY

Good / better / best, one software platform.



LORE Pebble $149

Clip-on, 42×42×14 mm, LED ring. 'Lite' design (D10): AI via phone over BLE; offline pre-generated stories. 1.5-day target.



LORE Square $299

54×54×12 mm aluminium, 1.6" AMOLED, crown. LTE Cat-1bis + global eSIM (D11), on-device 3B model. 2-day target.



LORE Atlas $599

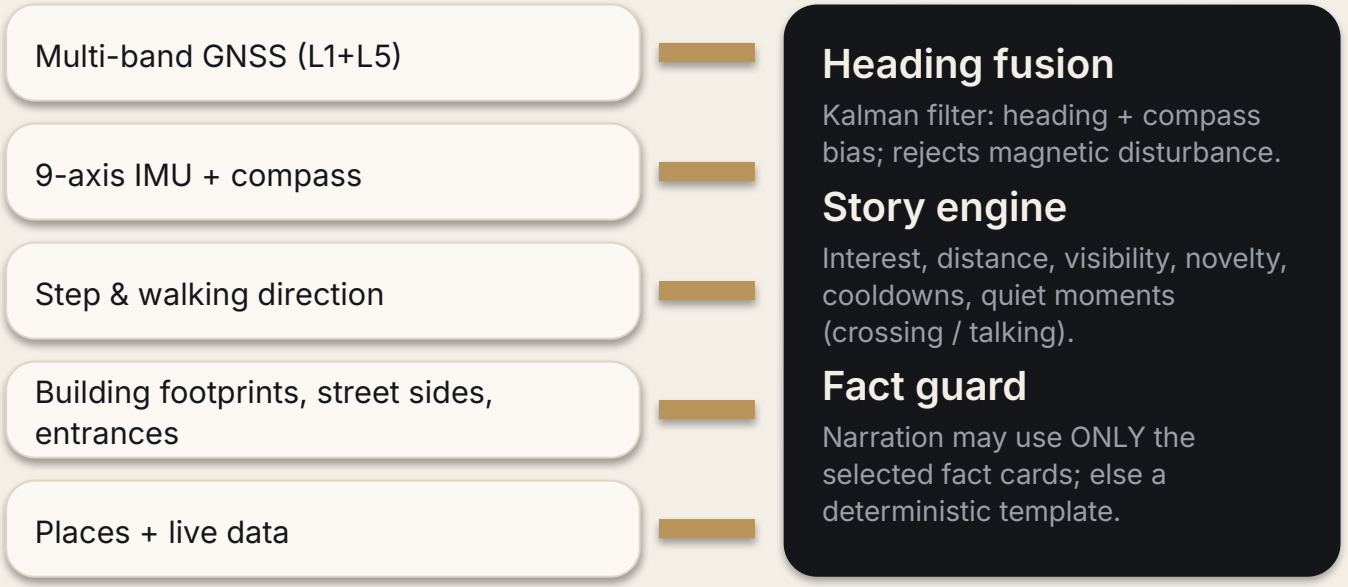
Titanium + sapphire, 13.5 mm (D12), Glance camera, satellite SOS (NTN). On-device 3-4B + vision. '2+ days'.

LORE Pass: Explorer $9.99/mo or $79/yr · Trip Pass $29 / 14 days / 5 GB · $49 / 30 days / 10 GB · free tier (3 cities). Every device includes 3 months of Explorer. **LORE Kit** accessories incl. LORE Buds $129.

Renders: design/industrial/renders (concept renders, not production units). Specs: COMPANY.md, hardware/README.md, decisions D8, D10-D12.

HOW MAP VISION WORKS

LORE 'sees' without a camera: sensor fusion + map geometry.



left · right · ahead · behind · look up

Simulated accuracy (hardware/simulations): left/right 99.9% with EKF + map-matching + L1/L5; EKF alone 98.9%; L1+L5 adds 3-7 points over L1-only.

Prototype walk (software sim): direction 100% vs ground truth; fused heading error mean 4.3°, p95 12.7°.

Gate G1 bar on real walks: ≥90%. D3 kill line: <85%.

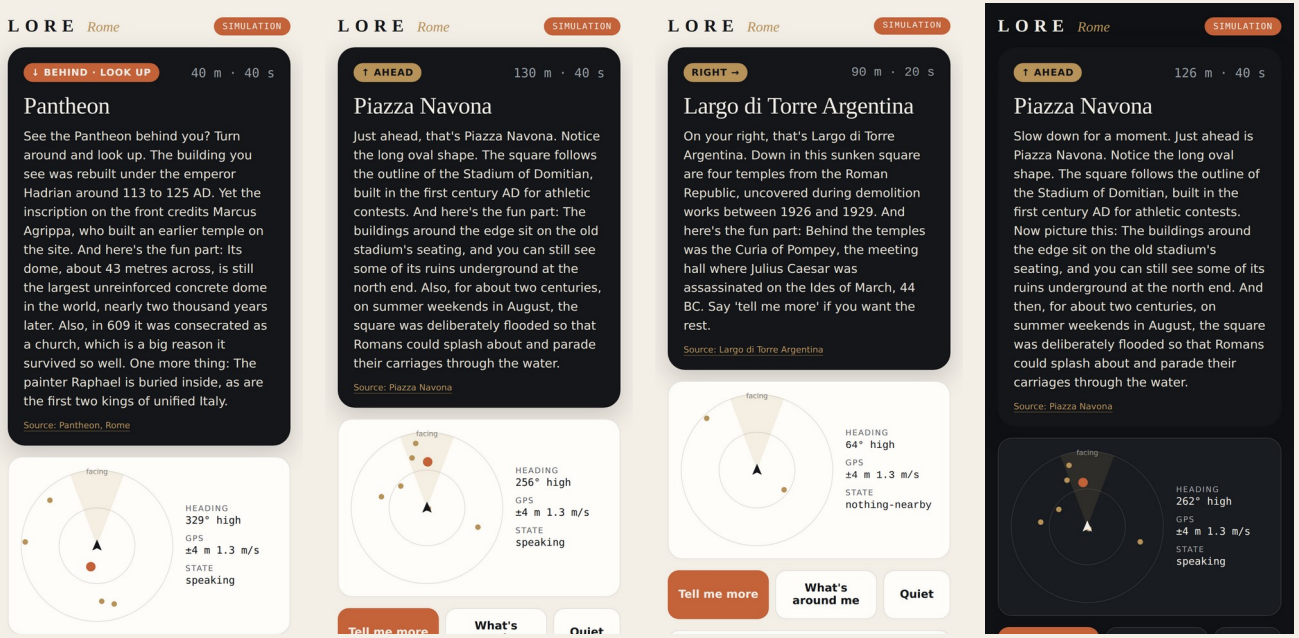
Why no camera on the first models (D3): avoids privacy problems, cost and battery drain. Only Atlas adds an opt-in 'Glance' camera. Patent provisionals planned before any public demo: P1 Map Vision, P2 quiet-moment (legal-ops/ip-strategy.md).

Caveat: all accuracy figures are SIMULATED. Real-walk validation in Rome starts with the EVT beta (Q1 2027).

Sources: hardware/README.md, hardware/simulations/results.md, software/packages/core (heading-fusion.ts, story-engine.ts, narration.ts).

DEMO: THE WORKING ROME PROTOTYPE

The real story engine, walking Pantheon to Trevi (1.93 km).



Simulation mode, phone viewport: Pantheon · Piazza Navona · 'What's around me' at Largo Argentina · dark 'storyteller' persona.

Walk-simulation metrics (SIMULATED)

Metric	Value
Narrations	17 (8.8 / km)
Facts spoken / repeats	39 / 0.0%
Quiet-moment compliance	100% (0 violations)
Direction accuracy vs truth	100%
Fused heading error	4.3° mean · 12.7° p95
Share of time speaking	26%
Rome City Pack	86 POIs · 215 fact cards
Tests passing	61 vitest + 16 pytest

What is not proven yet: no real-user walks, no EVT hardware. Seed facts are curated with Wikipedia citations but still need an online verify pass and editorial review before customers hear them. Gate G0 (Nov 2026-Jan 2027): 20 Rome walk tests + 200 remote sim users.

Sources: software/README.md, software/apps/prototype/screenshots/, software/simulations/output/rome-walk-transcript.md.

MARKET

A $10.7B/yr job market today; we size the beachhead bottom-up.

$10.7B

TAM (top-down, 2027): eSIM, audio guides, travel safety, AI-companion, self-guided tours

$24.0B

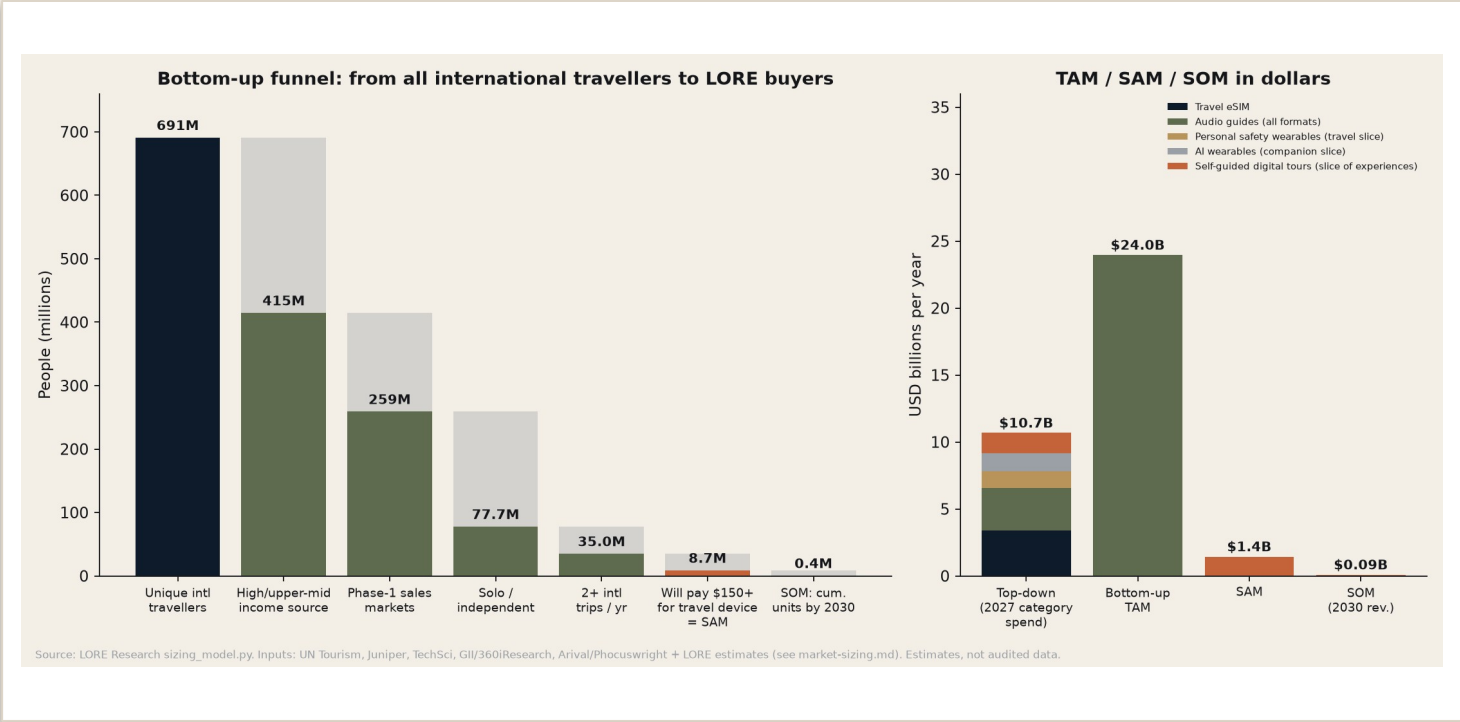
TAM (bottom-up): 145M frequent international travellers × $165 ARPU

$1.44B

SAM: 8.7M solo/independent travellers, 2+ trips/yr, US/CA/UK/EU/AU-NZ, will pay $150+

$93M

SOM 2030 base: 250k units in 2030, 415k cumulative (4.7% of SAM). Bear $46M / Bull $148M

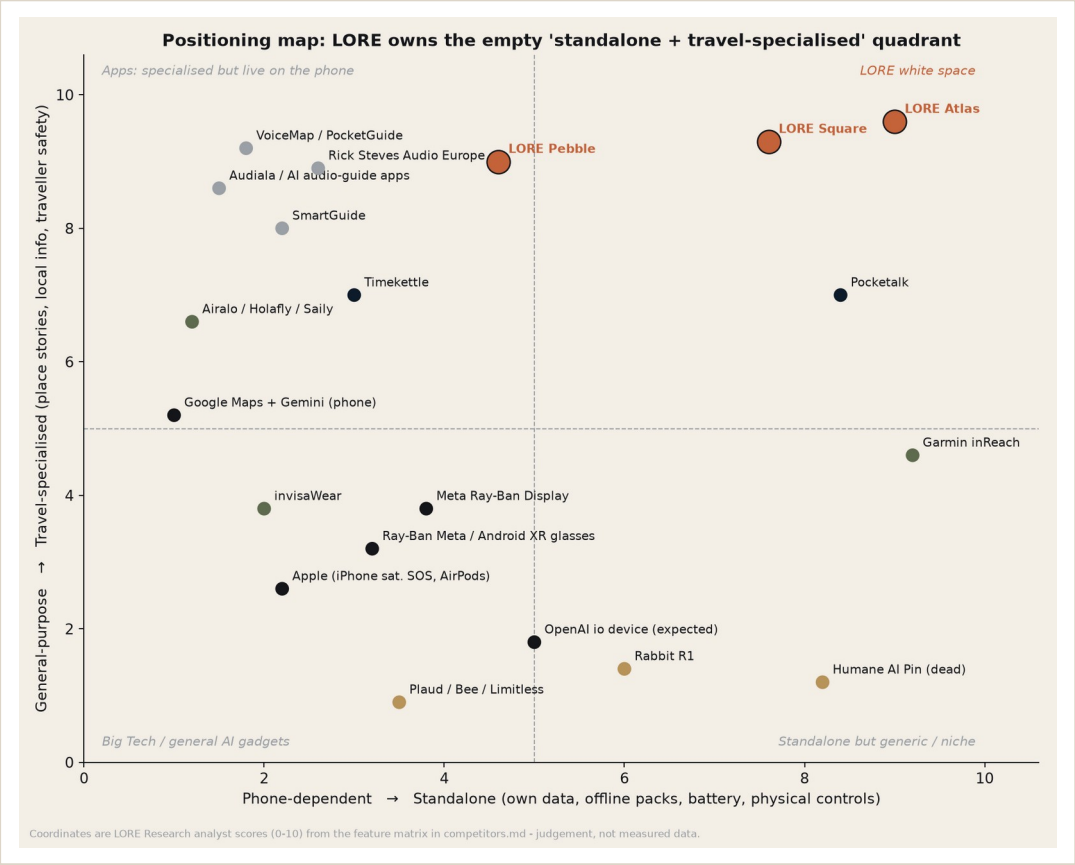


Tailwinds: 1.52B international arrivals in 2025 (+4%); top-100 city arrivals +8%; travel eSIM $1.8B (2025, +85%) → $8.7B (2030); solo-travel spend ~$482B (2024) → ~$1.07T (2030).

Source: research/market-sizing.md (all figures cited with URLs there), research/charts/market-size-waterfall.png. SOM is a Research estimate [EST].

COMPETITION AND POSITIONING

Nothing else is standalone, travel-first and verified.



Threat	What it is	Our answer
Google/Samsung Gemini glasses + Maps	Fall 2026; camera + assistant	Travel brain; works with any audio
Meta Ray-Ban / Display	~7M glasses sold 2025	No camera needed; $149 entry
Phone + AI-guide app + eSIM	Audiala $4.99/mo + Airalo	Battery, theft, eyes-up, SOS
OpenAI io device	H2 2026-27 (narrative)	Narrow job; verified facts

Lessons we design against: Humane (~10k units; assets sold to HP for $116M) and Rabbit (~130k sold, ~5% daily use) shipped general assistants with no daily job. Plaud (>1M devices, ~$250M run-rate) shows one narrow job + clip-on + subscription works.

Moat we are building: sourced City Packs and the fact-checking process; Map Vision IP; brand.

Source: research/competitors.md (30-product matrix, URLs inside), research/charts/positioning-map.png.

BUSINESS MODEL AND PRICING

Hardware gets us in; LORE Pass and bookings compound.

	Pebble	Square	Atlas
US price	$149	$299	$599
Kickstarter super early bird	$99	$199	$399
EU / UK	€159 / £149	€329 / £299	€649 / £599
Price anchor	Plaud NotePin S $179	Pocketalk Plus $299.95	inReach Mini 3+ $499 / Watch Ultra $799

Why these prices: Research's comparable-price ladder (research/pricing-research.md). Atlas raised $549 → $599 (D8), to be A/B tested; revert if the survey shows >20% loss of purchase intent.

Retention by design (the Rabbit lesson): annual Explorer at $79, a free tier that stays useful, home-city 'Weekend Walks', and retention KPIs reported to investors.

Hardware

DTC first; retail after returns <5%, led by Pebble + Atlas (D15)

LORE Pass

$9.99/mo · $79/yr · Trip Pass $29 / $49; 3 months free with every device

LORE Kit

Clip, lanyard, dock, case, LORE Buds $129, city bundles

Bookings

Affiliate fees: hotels, tours, restaurants

B2B fleet

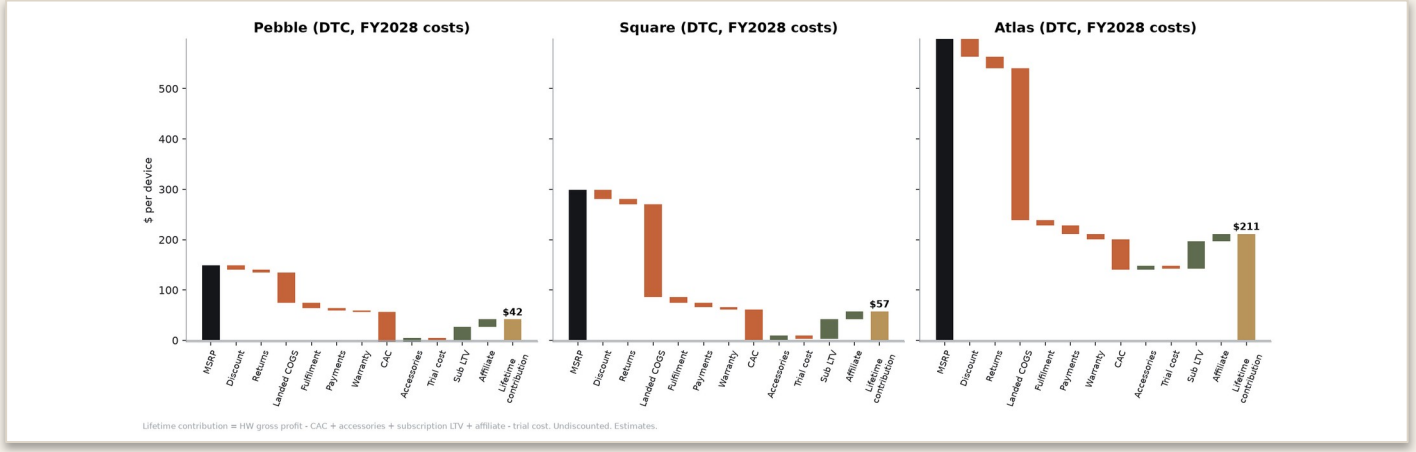
Rental for hostels and tour operators (pilots Q4 2027+)

Sources: COMPANY.md, research/pricing-research.md, company/decisions-log.md D6, D8, D15.

UNIT ECONOMICS

We found the margin problem early and changed the product.

Landed COGS @10k units	Before (full spec)	Decision	After
Pebble $149	$157 incl. NRE → −5% GM	D10: 'Lite' (AI via phone)	**~$90 → 39% GM**
Square $299	$299 incl. NRE → 0% GM	D11: LTE Cat-1bis, cost-down	**Target ≤$240 by unit 10k; $329 fallback**
Atlas $599	$413 incl. NRE → 25% at $549	D8 price $599; D12 13.5 mm	**Margin engine**
Any SKU, China FATP	Square $343 landed (tariffs)	D13: Vietnam / Malaysia	**0% duty assumed**



DTC hardware GM (H2-2028 cost): Pebble 42% · Square 23% · Atlas 37%. At launch, before the D11 cost-down, Square is only 7%.

Lifetime contribution per device: $42 / $57 / $211 incl. LORE Pass, accessories and affiliate, after $60 paid CAC.

LORE Pass GM ≈69% (2028) → ≈75% (2031); cloud + data ≈ $2.02 per paid user-month.

Biggest swing: if the Square cost-down fails, FY31 EBITDA is –$8.3M not +$0.8M. DVT gate Sep-2027: >$205 ex-NRE → price $329. Square is DTC-only until landed ≤$200 (D15).

Sources: hardware/README.md + hardware/bom/BOM.md (estimates, 2026 DRAM prices), finance/unit-economics.md, company/decisions-log.md D10-D13.

GO-TO-MARKET AND KICKSTARTER

Stories sell; safety justifies; Kickstarter proves demand.

Nov 26-Jan 27	Feb-Apr 27	Pre-launch	25 May-24 Jun 27	Q4 27	2028
Waitlist	**Rome beta**	**List + VIPs**	**Kickstarter**	**DTC**	**Retail / airport**
5k sign-ups	50 EVT units	20k emails, 2k $1 VIPs	$250k goal	First 5k units	after returns <5%

$1.04M

Kickstarter base case: 4,600 backers × $225 avg pledge (plan, not a result)

≈$50

Cost per backer on $230k marketing (Gate G2 needs <$60)

$554k

Conservative case: misses $1M; escalation playbook ready

$70

DTC blended CAC ceiling after launch

Channels: TikTok/IG organic ('Secrets of Rome') → paid lead gen ($2.75 CPL target) → creators (≤$45 CPB) → PR (15+ tier-1/2 articles) → email (8% list conversion).

Messaging: Look up · True stories · Go anywhere, safely. Lead with experience, justify with safety.

Honesty: no partners, customers or pre-orders exist yet; all named companies are targets.

Sources: gtm/README.md, gtm/gtm-strategy.md, gtm/kickstarter/, finance/kickstarter-economics.md.

ROADMAP, MILESTONES AND GATES

Each stage removes the biggest risk before we spend on the next.

Stage 0 · Nov 26-Jan 27

Prove the magic

Phone PWA + Rome pack (300+ places hand-checked); 20 Rome walks; n≥500 survey

G0: ≥40% 'very disappointed'; ≥60% finish a 30-min walk; ≥25% would pay $149+

Stage 1 · Feb-May 27

Prove the device

50 EVT units; ODM selected (VN/MY); SoC locked; pre-seed closes; first hires

G1: battery ≥1.5 days measured; left/right ≥90% on walks; beta use ≥3 days/week

Stage 2 · Jun-Aug 27

Prove demand

Kickstarter (25 May-24 Jun); 20k list; DVT; certification starts

G2: ≥$1M pledged; ≥3,000 backers; CPB <$60

Stage 3 · Sep 27-Apr 28

Ship

$6M seed; PVT → first 5k units; FCC/CE/UKCA/carriers; 1 → 8 cities; B2B pilots

G3: returns <5%; attach >55%; churn <6%/mo; NPS >50

What we will not do: no glasses; no camera before Atlas; ≤1 new city/month until City Pack quality is measured; no retail before DTC returns <5%. 2028: retail + 20 cities.

Source: company/operating-plan.md, COMPANY.md timeline, gtm/README.md.

TEAM AND HIRING

Founder-led today; the pre-seed buys the founding team.

Nimit Jain, Founder & CEO

Product, fundraising and story quality. Today every department (research, brand, design, hardware, software, finance, GTM, legal/ops, IR) is run as an AI-agent team with founder sign-off on every output; this deck is built from their files.

Contract-first, to de-risk

Industrial-design studio, EE/RF consultancy, ODM programme manager, fractional CFO and GC, patent/TM attorneys. Pre-seed team 6-8 people in 2027; ~20 at seed (2028).

#	First hires (pre-seed)	When
1	Founding Embedded / Firmware Lead	Nov 2026
2	Founding ML / Story-Engine Engineer	Nov 2026
3	Mobile + Backend Engineer	Dec 2026
4	Hardware / Electrical Lead (contract first)	Jan 2027
5	Sensor-Fusion / Map Vision Engineer	Jan 2027
6	Content Editor-in-Chief (City Packs)	Jan 2027
7	Growth & Community Lead (Kickstarter)	Feb 2027
8	Supply Chain & Quality Manager	Mar 2027

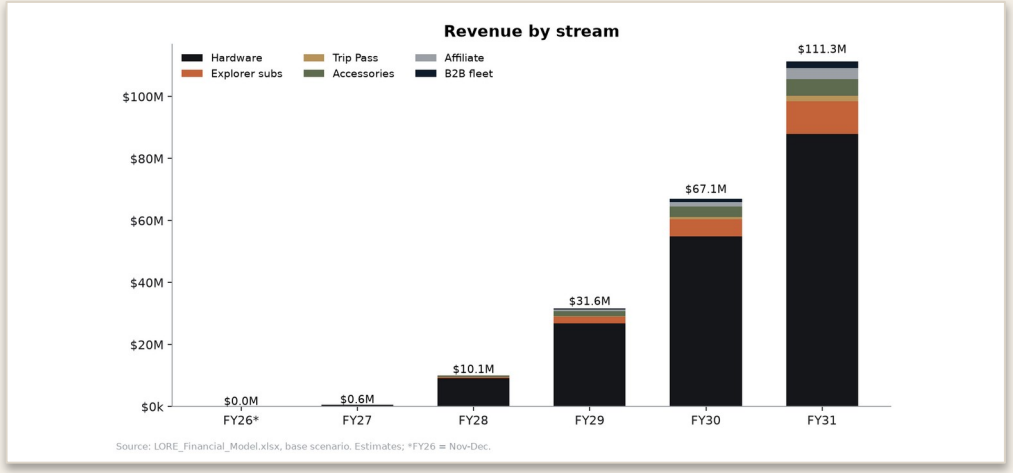
We are not claiming hires, advisors or investors that do not exist. Roles, salary bands (US/EU/IN) and equity bands: legal-ops/hr-hiring.md. 12% option pool planned.

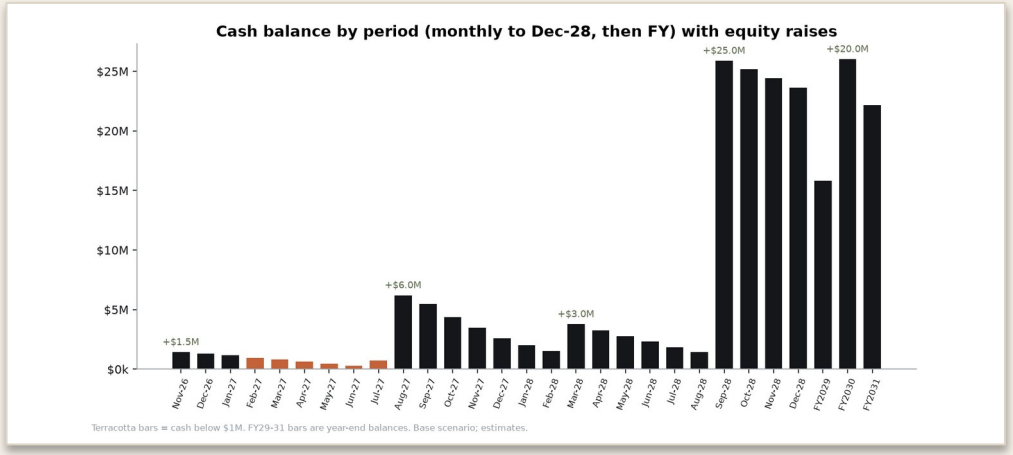
Sources: company/org-chart.md, legal-ops/hr-hiring.md, legal-ops/README.md.

FINANCIALS

Base case: $111M revenue and EBITDA-positive in FY2031.

Base case	FY27	FY28	FY29	FY30	FY31
Units	3.4k	40k	120k	250k	400k
Revenue	$596k	$10.1M	$31.6M	$67.1M	$111.3M
Gross margin	11%	27%	33%	38%	41%
EBITDA	-$4.2M	-$4.3M	-$7.2M	-$5.4M	$836k
Subscription ARR	$0	$798k	$3.3M	$7.6M	$13.6M





Scenarios FY31 revenue: Bear $56.2M · Base $111.3M · Bull $166.1M.

Funding need: $55.5M total equity to break-even (D16): pre-seed → $6M seed → $3M seed-2 → $25M A → $20M B. Bear case needs ≈$72M. At $1.5M the pre-seed bottomed at $278k in Jun-27, so the round is now $1.75M (D14).

Research cross-check: SOM 2030 base $93M (bear $46M / bull $148M).

Source: finance/LORE_Financial_Model.xlsx via finance/model_summary.json; finance/charts. All projections are estimates.

THE ASK

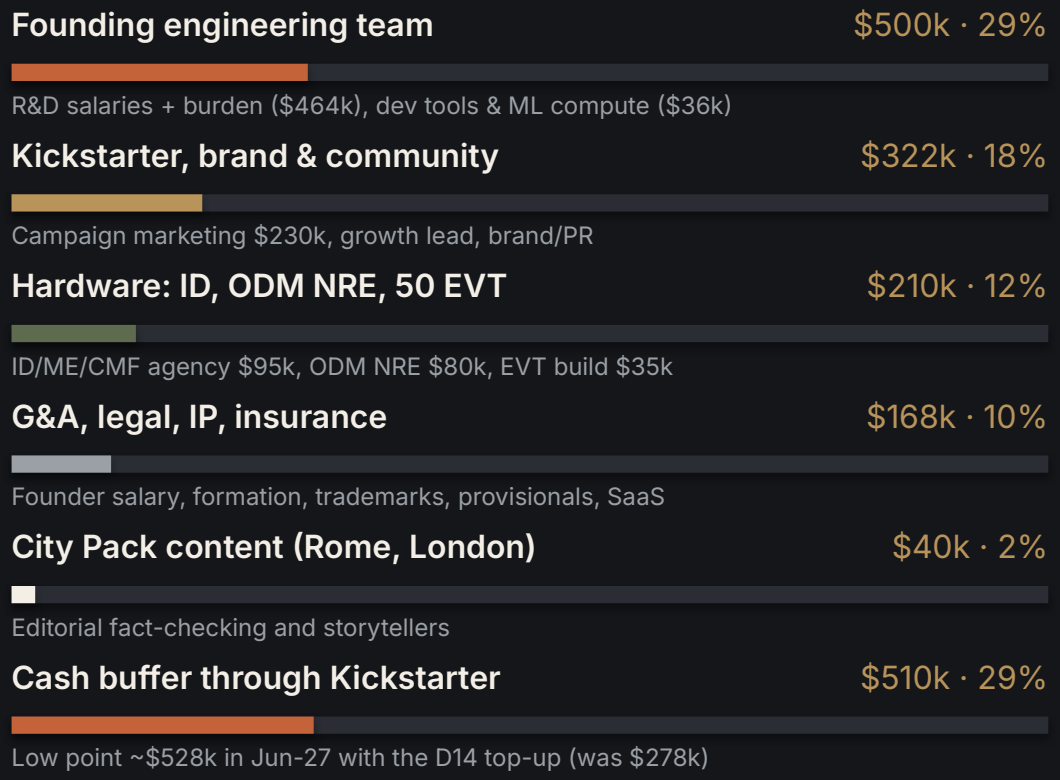
$1.75M pre-seed SAFE
$12M post-money cap

Gets us to: Gate G0 (product love), 50 EVT units and Gate G1, a $1M+ Kickstarter (Gate G2), and the $6M seed.

Investor owns: ≈14.6% at the $12M post-money cap. $1.5M + $250k top-up (D14).

Runway: Nov 2026 to the Kickstarter payout (Jun/Jul 2027) and the $6M seed (Aug 2027). The $250k top-up (D14) lifts the Jun-27 cash low from ~$278k to ~$0.5M.

Use of funds



Let's walk Rome together.

Live prototype demo on request. Data room index: investor/data-room-index.md

Nimit Jain
Founder & CEO, LORE Labs, Inc.
nimitjain.248@gmail.com · India